Worse than War:
The Global Costs of Violence
Codebook

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1 Introduction

This codebook describes the key data, estimations and methods used in the book "Worse than War: The Global Costs of Violence" (Hoeffler and Fearon (2026)). The accompanying datasets compiles numerous data collection efforts by researchers across the globe who are working in the public health sector, development, research institutes, IGOs, NGOs, and statistical offices, amongst others. The purpose of this codebook is to provide a comprehensive overview of data sources, variables and definitions.

The data used to produce the figures and tables in the book are available at https://github.com/jfearon4/Global-Costs-of-Violence

2 Country Codes, Classifications, and Population

2.0.1 Country

ccode: Numeric code uniquely identifying each country (nominal).
Sources: The Correlates of War Project (2016), supplemented by James Fearon.

- Countrycodes generally follow the COW countrycodes. In case a country was missing a COW country code, it was supplemented (see Table 1).

2.0.2 Region

region: Abbreviations used to indicate the world's regions (nominal).
Sources: The World Bank (2022).

Categories:

- *Asia*: Afghanistan, Bangladesh, Bhutan, Brunei, Cambodia, China, China; Macao SAR, Cook Islands, East Timor, Fiji, French Polynesia, Guam, Hong Kong, India, Indonesia, Japan, Kiribati, Laos, Malaysia, Maldives, Marshall Islands, Micronesia, Mongolia, Myanmar, Nauru, Nepal, New Caledonia, Niue, North Korea, Pakistan, Palau, Papua New Guinea, Philippines, Republic of Vietnam, Samoa, Singapore, Solomon Islands, South Korea, Sri Lanka, Taiwan, Thailand, Tonga, Tuvalu, Vanuatu, Vietnam

Country	Countrycode
Serbia	345
French Guiana	901
French Polynesia	902
Greenland	903
Guadeloupe	904
Guam	905
Martinique	906
Mayotte	907
Montserrat	908
New Caledonia	909
Niue	911
Puerto Rico	912
Reunion	913
Saint Pierre and Miquelon	914
Palestinian Territories	915
Turks and Caicos Islands	916
United States Virgin Islands	917
Holy See	918
Anguilla	991
Aruba	992
Bermuda	993
Virgin Islands (U.K.)	994
Cayman Islands	995
Hong Kong SAR, China	996
China, Macao SAR	997
Cook Islands	998

Table 1: Countrycodes supplemented by James Fearon.

- *Eastern Europe (EEur)*: Albania, Armenia, Azerbaijan, Belarus, Bosnia and Herzegovina, Bulgaria, Croatia, Czech Republic, Czechoslovakia, Estonia, Georgia, Hungary, Kazakhstan, Kosovo, Kyrgyzstan, Latvia, Lithuania, Macedonia, Moldova, Montenegro, Poland, Romania, Russia, Serbia, Slovakia, Slovenia, Tajikistan, Turkmenistan, Ukraine, Uzbekistan

- *Latin America & the Caribbean (LA/Ca)*: Anguilla, Antigua, Argentina, Aruba, Bahamas, Barbados, Belize, Bermuda, Bolivia, Brazil, British Virgin Islands, Cayman Islands, Chile, Colombia, Costa Rica, Cuba, Dominica, Dominican Republic, Ecuador, El Salvador, French Guiana, Grenada, Guadeloupe, Guatemala, Guyana, Haiti, Honduras, Jamaica, Martinique, Mexico, Montserrat, Nicaragua, Panama, Paraguay, Peru, Puerto Rico, St. Kitts and Nevis, St. Lucia, St. Vincent and the Grenadines, Suriname, Trinidad and Tobago, Turks and Caicos Islands, United States Virgin Islands, Uruguay, Venezuela

- *North Africa & the Middle East (NA/ME)*: Algeria, Bahrain, Cyprus, Egypt, Iran, Iraq, Israel, Jordan, Kuwait, Lebanon, Libya, Morocco, Oman, Palestine, Qatar, Saudi Arabia, Syria, Tunisia, Turkey, United Arab Emirates, Yemen, Yemen Arab Republic, Yemen People's Republic

- *Sub-Saharan Africa (SSA)*: Angola, Benin, Botswana, Burkina Faso, Burundi, Cameroon, Cape Verde, Central African Republic, Chad, Comoros, Democratic Republic of the Congo, Djibouti, Equatorial Guinea, Eritrea, Ethiopia, Gabon, Gambia, Ghana, Guinea, Guinea-Bissau, Ivory Coast, Kenya, Lesotho, Liberia, Madagascar, Malawi, Mali, Mauritania, Mauritius, Mayotte, Mozambique, Namibia, Niger, Nigeria, Republic of the Congo, Reunion, Rwanda, Sao Tome and Principe, Senegal, Seychelles, Sierra Leone, Somalia, South Africa, South Sudan, Sudan, Swaziland, Tanzania, Togo, Uganda, Zambia, Zanzibar, Zimbabwe

- *West*: Andorra, Australia, Austria, Belgium, Canada, Denmark, Finland, France, German Democratic Republic, German Federal Republic, Germany, Greece, Greenland, Holy See, Iceland, Ireland, Italy, Liechtenstein, Luxembourg, Malta, Monaco, Netherlands, New Zealand, Norway, Portugal, Saint Pierre and Miquelon, San Marino, Spain, Sweden, Switzerland, United Kingdom, United States of America

2.0.3 Income

income: The abbreviations we used to indicate a countries' income group, following the classification of the World Bank for July 2021 (ordinal).
Sources: The World Bank (2022).

Categories:

- *Low-income countries (GNI per capita of $1,045 or less)*: Afghanistan, Burkina Faso, Burundi, Central African Republic, Chad, Dem. Rep of Congo, Eritrea, Ethiopia, Gambia, Guinea, Guinea-Bissau, Liberia, Madagascar, Malawi, Mali, Mozambique, Niger, North Korea, Rwanda, Sierra Leone, Somalia, South Sudan, Sudan, Syria, Togo, Uganda, Yemen

- *Lower-middle income countries ($1,046 to $4,095)*: Algeria, Angola, Bangladesh, Belize, Benin, Bhutan, Bolivia, Cabo Verde, Cambodia, Cameroon, Comoros, Côte d'Ivoire, Djibouti, Egypt; Arab Rep., El Salvador, Eswatini, Ghana, Haiti, Honduras, India, Indonesia, Iran, Kenya, Kiribati, Lao, Lesotho, Mauritania, Micronesia, Mongolia, Morocco, Myanmar, Nepal, Nicaragua, Nigeria, Pakistan, Papua New Guinea, Philippines, Republic of the Congo, Samoa, São Tomé and Principe, Senegal, Solomon Islands, Sri Lanka, Tajikistan, Tanzania, Timor-Leste, Tunisia, Ukraine, Uzbekistan, Vanuatu, Vietnam, West Bank and Gaza, Zambia, Zimbabwe

- *Upper-middle income economies ($4,096 to $12,695)*: Albania, American Samoa, Argentina, Armenia, Azerbaijan, Belarus, Bosnia and Herzegovina, Botswana, Brazil, Bulgaria, China, Colombia, Costa Rica, Cuba, Dominica, Dominican Republic, Ecuador, Equatorial Guinea, Fiji, Gabon, Georgia, Grenada, Guatemala, Guyana, Iraq, Jamaica, Jordan, Kazakhstan, Kosovo, Lebanon, Libya, Malaysia, Maldives, Marshall Islands, Mauritius, Mexico, Moldova, Montenegro, Namibia, North Macedonia, Panama, Paraguay, Peru, Romania, Russia, Serbia, South Africa, St. Lucia, St. Vincent and the Grenadines, Suriname, Thailand, Tonga, Turkey, Turkmenistan, Tuvalu
- *High-income countries ($12,696 or more)*: Andorra, Antigua and Barbuda, Aruba, Australia, Austria, Bahamas, Bahrain, Barbados, Belgium, Bermuda, British Virgin Islands, Brunei, Canada, Cayman Islands, Channel Islands, Chile, Croatia, Curaçao, Macao, Cyprus, Czech Republic, Denmark, Estonia, Faroe Islands, Finland, France, French Polynesia, Germany, Gibraltar, Greece, Greenland, Guam, Hong Kong; China, Hungary, Iceland, Ireland, Israel, Italy, Japan, Kuwait, Latvia, Liechtenstein, Lithuania, Luxembourg, Malta, Monaco, Nauru, Netherlands, New Caledonia, New Zealand, Northern Mariana Islands, Norway, Oman, Palau, Poland, Portugal, Puerto Rico, Qatar, San Marino, Saudi Arabia, Seychelles, Singapore, Slovak Republic, Slovenia, South Korea, Spain, St. Kitts and Nevis, St. Martin, Sweden, Switzerland, Taiwan; China, Trinidad and Tobago, Turks and Caicos Islands, United Arab Emirates, United Kingdom, United States, Uruguay, Virgin Islands (U.S.)

2.0.4 Population

pop: Population variables, total or by sex and age group [e.g. *pop.fem0.4* for the female population from age 0 to 4] (continuous).
Sources: United Nations, Department of Economic and Social Affairs, Population Division (2024). If missing, we complemented the population variable with Worldbank data or census data by the Kosovo Agency of Statistics (2011).

- Missing data for sex and age group are: Holy See
- In the case of Kosovo, we relied on data of the Kosovo Agency of Statistics. As World Bank data are unavailable by sex and age group, we filled in the variable using data provided by the Kosovo Agency of Statistics (2011):
    1. For 2011, we used census data with population data by sex and age group.
    2. For 2017-2019, we used the population projection (medium variant) by sex and age group.
    3. For the years 2012-2016, we imputed the values using the mean values of 2011 and 2017.
- **pop.child**: A child is defined as aged 0 - 14.

3 Prevalence of Violence

3.1 Collective Violence

Collective violence is defined as "violence inflicted by larger groups such as states, organized political groups, militia groups and terrorist organizations." (Krug et al., 2002, 215). We consider two main forms of collective violence: armed conflict and terrorism.

3.1.1 Armed Conflict

A country-year observation is defined as in conflict if there are at least 25 fatalities per year (Sundberg and Melander, 2013, 5).

armed.conflict: Highest reliable estimate of fatalities stemming from battle-related, one-sided and non-state violence (numeric).
Sources: UCDP Georeferenced Event Dataset (GED) Global version 22.1 (1989-2020) (Sundberg and Melander, 2013).

- We summed up the fatalities from UCDP GED, which is an event-based data set, by country-year. For countries belonging to the region "West", we set *armed.conflict* to zero as we assume that there are no non-terrorist events on "Western ground".

3.1.2 Terrorism

The main data source for terrorism is the Global Terrorism Database (GTD) where terrorism is defined "as the threatened or actual use of illegal force and violence by a non-state actor to attain a political, economic, religious, or social goal through fear, coercion, or intimidation" (START, 2021, 11). We combine these data with the UCDP Georeferenced Event Dataset (GED) to derive estimates for the terrorism fatalities that occurred outside of armed conflicts. Specifically, we use the following data sources:

terrorism: Fatalities from events listed in the GTD but not in the GED (numeric).
Sources: UCDP Georeferenced Event Dataset (GED) Global version 19.1 (1989-2018) (Sundberg and Melander, 2013). However, Donnay et al. (2019) base their estimates on the UCDP GED Version 17.1 for Africa (1997-2016).

Global Terrorism Database (GTD) (1970-2019) by START (2022).
GTD (1970-2019), "Terrorism in Armed Conflict" (TAC) for UCDP actors and GTD actors (1970-2013) by Fortna, Lotito and Rubin (2022).

Estimation of the terrorism fatalities:

- We summed up the fatalities from GTD, which is an event-based data set, by country-year.
- We use the mean value of the variable we generated based on the meltt package by Donnay et al. (2019) and the variable based on Fortna, Lotito and Rubin (2022). This is because we perceive them as lower and upper bounds of fatalities due to terrorism.
- Donnay et al. (2019) created a R package called "meltt" which allows us to match events from GED and GTD. Since the coding of the exact time and location in the event databases is "fuzzy", both databases can then be matched imperfectly based on an acceptable degree of spatiotemporal "fuzziness". We allowed for 5 kilometers and 1 day uncertainty in the algorithm's definition of proximity, i.e. the spatiotemporal realm in which events are examined more closely to find out whether they constitute the same event. To create the "pure terrorism" variable *terrorism.alone.meltt* we proceeded as follows:
  - From the integration information from Donnay et al. (2019), we calculated the proportion of GTD fatalities that stemmed from events that did not occur in the GED, but that could be attributed to "pure terrorism" (*prop.pure*). We excluded situations where either the GTD or the GED are 0 or N.A.) because we wanted to focus only on situations where both databases could potentially be overlapping.
  - Using *prop.pure*, we calculated the global mean ratio of GTD data that did not overlap with GED data in situations where it would have been possible (*ratio*).
  - Whenever we had information from Donnay et al. (2019) on the actual proportion of GTD fatalities that did not stem from events overlapping with GED in that country-year (cy) we used the (most recent) GTD fatality estimate without the deaths stemming from events that have been in the GED as well: *df$gtd · df$prop.pure*
  - If we did not have any information on the actual proportion of GTD fatalities not stemming from events also listed in GED,[1] we applied the mean *ratio* to the most recent available GTD estimates for that country-year: *df$gtd · ratio*
    An exception from this is, when the country belongs to the region "West". In those cases, we only used GTD estimates, without any consideration of GED as there has not been any armed conflict in any Western country

[1] Because the respective country was not in Africa.

from 2000 to 2020, and therefore, events happening in that time frame on Western territory are probably all due to terrorism.

  - When there was either no *armed.conflict* value or the newest available GED fatality estimate was zero, we simply used the *gtd* estimate.

- Fortna, Lotito and Rubin (2022) created a taxonomy linking actors from GTD to the armed groups listed by UCDP.[2] We use their approach to filter out all GTD events committed by said armed groups. We define the overlap between GED and GTD by having the same actor groups and "pure terrorism" as events, which have not been committed by armed groups (listed by UCDP). From the matching levels made available by Fortna, Lotito and Rubin (2022) , we chose the level E. This entails that we allow everything from direct matches and armed wings of the (UCDP), *SideB* group, over factions, allies, connections that are unclear or change over time as well as generic descriptors, which apply to *SideB*. However, we excluded potential matches derived from generic descriptors, which are vague or very general (e.g. "unknown" or "individuals"). After we filtered out those events with actors linked to armed groups as defined by UCDP, we summed up the fatalities per country-year. Since the link for GTD and UCDP actors is available only for events from the years up to 2013, we applied the ratio of events that have been committed by armed groups in 2013 to subsequent country years. We then subtract the fatalities from events committed by armed groups from the total GTD fatalities. An exception is that for countries belonging to the "West", we used the original GTD fatality estimate, without any corrections.

3.1.3 Collective Violence Estimates

colvio: Estimate of fatalities stemming from battle-related, one-sided, and non-state violence or terrorism (numeric).
Sources: UCDP Georeferenced Event Dataset (GED) Global version 19.1 (1989-2018), GTD (1970-2019). Whenever we use Donnay et al. (2019): UCDP GED Version 17.1 for Africa (1997-2016), GTD for Africa (1997-2016) and their integration.

- Sum of *armed.conflict* and *terrorism*. For countries belonging to the region "West" we used the values from the GTD database.

3.2 Interpersonal Violence

Interpersonal violence is defined as "violence inflicted by an individual or a small group of individuals" (Krug et al., 2002, 6).

[2]This was originally done to see whether armed groups use terrorist tactics, i.e. events listed in the GTD.

3.2.1 Homicide

Intentional homicide is defined as "unlawful death inflicted upon a person with the intent to cause death or serious injury" (UNODC 2015; 2019) .

hom: Highest reliable estimate of homicides (numeric).
Sources: UNODC (2000-2018) 2023, WHO Global Health Observatory (2020) (2000-2019)

- Both sources provide count estimates of homicides. We combined both data sets and took the higher value. This is due to homicides being underreported. In combining both datasets we were able to extend the numbers of observations available. When directly comparing both data sources with each other, we discovered that no one source is higher than the other all the way through. Although GHO data are generally higher, the GHO wildly underestimates Nigeria. We suspect that this is because the UNODC sponsored the data collection through an existing Nigerian household survey (UNODC 2023, 51). As terrorism is part of the UNODC's definition of homicide, we subtracted *gtd* from *hom*. However, we only applied this rule to Western countries, as we assume that their official homicide reporting is sufficiently accurate.

3.2.2 Assault

Broadly speaking, assault is defined as bodily harm caused by another.

assault: Highest reliable estimate of assaults (numeric).
Sources: Afrobarometer (2021) (2002-2014, but only some years), ICVS et al. (2003) (2003), Latin American Public Opinion Project (2018) (LAPOP) (2004-2014), Latinobarómetro (2018) (2000-2014), East Asia Barometer (2009) (2001-2008), Gallup Analytics, World Poll (2020) (2015-2019)

- We took the maximum of the survey-based assault values (which is just any data we have, since there are no multiple estimate country years). All sources provide percentages, of which we created counts and rates using the population data.
- The definitions of the different surveys we combined differ slightly:
  - Afrobarometer: Over the past year, how often, if ever, have you or anyone in your family been physically attacked?
  - ICVS: Apart from the incidents just covered, have you over the past five years been personally attacked or threatened by someone in a way that really frightened you, either at home or elsewhere, such as in a pub, in the street, at school, on public transport, on the beach, or at your workplace?

  - LAPOP: Having experienced a violent crime in the last 12 months. We added up the answers to the questions 2 (unarmed robbery with assault or physical threats). Weighted by a factor of 0.3, which is based on the assumption that 30 percent of armed robberies involve violence by Cook (1987), we included 3 (Armed robbery), 4 (Assault but not robbery), and 6 (Kidnapping).
  - Latino Barometer: Having experienced a violent crime in the last 12 months.
  - East Asia Barometer: In the past 12 months, have you or any member of your family been a victim of physical violence? (QII37)
  - Gallup: Within the past 12 months, have you been assaulted or mugged?

- A general issue: We have Gallup estimates for a large sample of countries, but these are all for the time period 2015-2019. There is good evidence that assault rates have been trending down pretty much everywhere (probably because of aging populations). So the use of this data may understate the true average rates for 2000-2019 for many countries that have only a Gallup number.
- Note that it is also possible that some of the assaults referred to in these estimates are sexual assaults, thus including assaults also counted in the "violence against women" estimates.
- We did not use UNODC data as they use government-reported values and our comparison to the survey-based values suggests massive underreporting.

3.2.3 Violence Against Women

3.2.3.1 Intimate Partner Violence

intimpar.vio / intimpar.sex.vio: Number of women (aged 15-49) affected by physical and/or sexual intimate partner violence (IPV) in the past 12 months (numeric).
Sources: World Health Organization (2021) (2000-2018).

Our main source for the creation of this variable was the Annex 6 of the WHO Violence Against Women report World Health Organization (2021). These prevalence estimates are given in percentages of ever-partnered women, but we want to provide a prevalence rate per 100,000 population over the past twelve months. Although we are aware that there are also non-partnered women, we made no further adjustments to the data.

In the DHS Domestic Violence Module there are a number of detailed questions regarding the husband's/partner's behavior. These questions include (in the past 12 months) did/has your partner/husband:

- push you, shake you, or throw something at you?
- slap you?

- twist your arm or pull your hair?
- punch you with his fist or with something that could hurt you?
- kick you, drag you, or beat you up?
- try to choke you or burn you on purpose?
- threaten or attack you wiht a knife, gun or other weapon?
- physically forced you to have sexual intercourse with him when you did not want to?
- physically forced you to perform any other sexual acts you did not want to?
- forced you with threats or in any other way to perform sexual acts you did not want to?

3.2.3.2 Sexual Violence - Non-partner

nonpar.sex.vio: Number of women who experienced sexual violence from non-partners (numeric).
Sources: ICVS et al. (2003), European Agency for Fundamental Rights (2014), OSCE (2017), DHS (2000-2018, only some years), United Nations (2015) (2000-2015, only some years), meta study on China by So-Kum Tang and Lai (2008) (2000-2006).

According to the UN international classification scheme *sexual violence* includes the categories *rape* and *sexual assault*. Rape is defined as the sexual penetration without valid consent, were penetration refers to the penetration of the vulva, anus or mouth with any body part or object. *Sexual assault* covers any unwanted sexual act that does not amount to rape. Examples include unwanted groping and fondling, sexual harassment and drug facilitated sexual assault (UNODC 2015). We did not use any UNODC data for sexual violence against women as they use government reported values and comparison to the survey based values suggests massive under-reporting. We therefore relied on the victimization surveys.

- For every country-year, we took the maximum of the survey based sexual violence values if there were values from several sources available.
- The definitions of the different surveys we combined slightly differ:
  - ICVS: Sexual assault against women; one-year prevalence rates in 2003/04, 2016

* Question: *First, a rather personal question. People sometimes grab, touch or assault others for sexual reasons in a really offensive way. This can happen either at home, or elsewhere, for instance in a pub, the street, at school, on public transport, in cinemas, on the beach, or at one's workplace.*
* If the answer was yes, respondents are asked: Could you describe what happened? Was it ... a rape, attempted rape, indecent actions, offensive behavior.

– FRA: Women who have experienced sexual violence in the 12 months before the interview by non-partners; age group 18-74. Based on the previous answers on lifetime experiences since the age of 15, the interviewer then asks: You said that a person [READ OUT THE RELEVANT CATEGORY ...]. Can I just ask, how often has this happened to you in the past 12 months? Answers range from never, once, 2-3 times, 4-5 times and more than six times. Furthermore the participants are asked who perpetrated the sexual assault, options are: colleague/co-worker, boss/supervisor, client/customer/patient, teacher /trainer /coach, another pupil/co-student, doctor/health care worker, relative/family member (other than partner), a date/someone you just met, friend/acquaintance, somebody else you knew, someone you did not know.
  * Forced you into sexual intercourse by holding you down or hurting you in some way? (IF NEEDED ADD: By sexual intercourse we mean here forced oral sex, forced anal or vaginal penetration)
  * Attempted to force you into sexual intercourse by holding you down or hurting you in some way? (IF NEEDED ADD: By sexual intercourse we mean here forced oral sex, forced anal or vaginal penetration)
  * Made you take part in any form of sexual activity when you did not want to or you were unable to refuse?
  * Or have you consented to sexual activity because you were afraid of what might happen if you refused?

– OSCE: Women who have experienced sexual violence in the 12 months before the interview by non-partners; age group 18-74. This research is based on the methodology used by FRA for its 2012 survey on violence against women in 28 European Union member states.
  * Question: *Since you were 15 years old until now, how often has someone done any of the following to you. Please exclude here your current partner and any previous partner you may have had.*
  - Forced you into sexual intercourse by holding you down or hurting you in some way?
  - Apart from this, attempted to force you into sexual intercourse by holding you down or hurting you in some way?
  - Apart from this, made you take part in any form of sexual activity when you did not want to or you were unable to refuse?

- Have you consented to sexual activity because you were afraid of what might happen if you refused?
- Threatened you with violent sexual acts (like rape, forced pregnancy, etc.) in a way that really frightened you?

* Can I just ask, how often has this happened to you in the past 12 months?

– DHS: Women who experienced sexual violence in past 12 months.

* Has anyone (other than your husband/partner) physically forced you to have sexual intercourse when you did not want to? (for single women this question is just asked as "has anyone physically ...")

– UN: Prevalence of sexual violence against women percent last 12 months.

* Put together by the UN Stats division; Includes DHS, other surveys, and data put together by UN Stats by direct communication with their field offices; the report from 2017 adds country-years but when they have values for the same country-year, the values from the 2017 report differ from the report from 2015, except for one time, and are often lower.

– Meta study on China: So-Kum Tang and Lai (2008) provide a meta study that assesses the quality of studies and aggregates them to provide estimates (for studies covering years from 1987 to 2006). They estimate the yearly prevalence of physical intimate partner violence at 6.7% and sexual violence at 5.4%. This percentage was applied to the female population aged 18-60, for all country-years after 1999.

- All sources provide percentages, of which we created counts and rates using the population data. Since the age groups of the surveys differ, we multiplied the percentages of ICSV, DHS and the UN with the female population aged 15-49 and the ones from FRA and OSCE with the female population aged 18-74. As with all the other variables, the rates per 100,000 population calculated later thereof are in respect to the whole population.

3.2.4 Violence Against Children

3.2.4.1 Severe Physical Punishment

Severe physical punishment is defined as caregivers hitting or slapping a child on the face, head or ears or beating them with an implement repeatedly (see Figure 1).

child.pun: Number of children affected from severe physical punishment (numeric).
Sources: UNICEF (2005-2015, only some countries and some years, only 71 countries

with a "severe punishment" estimate) by UNICEF (2022) and UNICEF (2016). We used single country sources on Canada (2018) by Institut de la Statistique du Québec (2018), UK (2009) by Radford et al. (2011), Sweden (2011) by Janson, Jembro and Långberg (2011), Denmark (2008) by Helweg-Larsen, Schütt and Larsen (2009), and China (2005) by Leung et al. (2008) .

This variable is a maximum coverage measure constructed from the UNICEF data on severe violent discipline and a variable which combines different sources on previously missing countries.

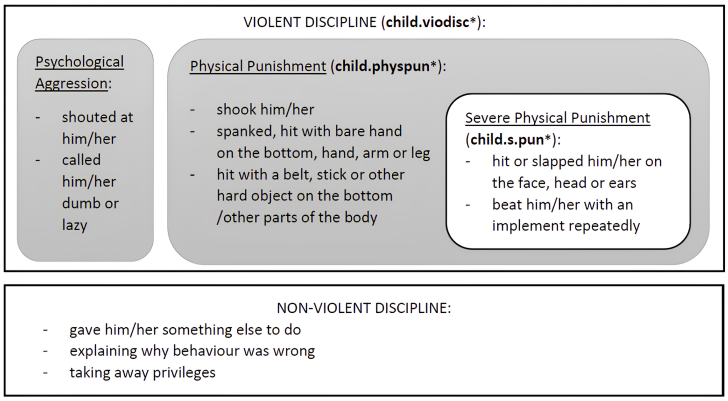


Figure 1: Child discipline definitions by UNICEF (2022).

The UNICEF data is given in percentages of the child population. Therefore, we applied these percentages to *pop.child*[3] to get count estimates. We corrected the values for New Zealand. Because the measure for physical punishment was used for severe punishment, we moved the value to the right place (i.e. physical punishment) and set the value for severe punishment to NA.

- *child.s.pun*: Per definition of the MICS surveys (see Figure 1), severe physical punishment consists of hitting or slapping the child on the face, head or ears, or beating it with an implement repeatedly. Therefore, shaking the child, spanking the child with the bare hand on the bottom, hand, arm or leg as well as hitting it with a belt, stick or other hard object on the bottom or other parts of the body, are considered to be physical punishment but not severe physical punishment. In the surveys included in the UNICEF data the respondents were mothers or primary care givers of 2-14 year olds[4]. They were asked about whether they, or any other member in the household, had used one of the listed disciplining methods during the past month.

[3]Children are defined as 0-14 years old.
[4]In some country surveys, children are defined as 3-17 year olds.

- *child.s.pun12.indiv*: This variable is the result of a research effort with the intent to supplement child violence data for previously missing countries. Due to the different sources, the violence definitions, age categories, respondents, and perpetrators varied from source to source. But we tried to put together somewhat comparable data fitting into similar categories. Therefore, we used only data referring to the last 12 months at the time of the survey.[5] When there was data from several sources on the same country-year and variable, we used their mean.
- To create the final count variable, we applied the percentages[6] to *pop.child* to get count estimates.[7]
- When there were single forms of violence given, we assigned them to our different violence variables as displayed in Table 2, trying to stay as close to the MICS definition as possible. Later, when there were several values for the same country-year per variable stemming from these single forms of violence, we took the maximum per child violence variable of these single forms.

single form of violence	violence variable it was assigned to
pulled by hair	child.physpun
pushed	child.physpun
slapping	child.physpun
mild slap on face	child.physpun
slap on bottom	child.physpun
resounding slap on face	child.s.pun (because it is to the face)
hit with fist	child.s.pun
beating	child.s.pun
beating with object	child.s.pun
beating with flat hand	child.physpun (don't know to which body part)
severe beating	child.s.pun
kicked	child.s.pun

Table 2: Single forms of violence and the violence variables we assigned them to.

More information on the single country sources we ended up using:

- Denmark (2008)[8]
  - Violence Definitions:

[5] As opposed to asking about lifetime experiences of violence.

[6] We left out count data we found - as it is data from official sources which probably underestimates the actual number by a lot and there is percentage data for most of the respective country-years.

[7] It is important to note that the data is for very different age groups! We are taking them as a proxy for the whole child population here though.

[8] Helweg-Larsen, Schütt and Larsen (2009) conducted a survey of 3,976 9th grade students from most of the country's municipalities. They were asked whether they experienced these forms of violence in the past 12 months by their father or mother.

    - Verbal (non-physical violence): Get angry, scolding, threats, throwing things
    - Mild physical violence: Pushed, shaken, pulled hair, beaten with flat hand
    - serious physical violence: Beaten with fist, with object, kicked, threatened with knife or other weapon or else violently
  - Only values separated by gender of the parents and the children given. Therefore:
    - For different children's sexes / same parent's sex: We took the mean because percentage of whole children population lies probably in-between of how often boys and girls get beaten.
    - When aggregating the different parent's sexes we took the maximum because children get beaten at least as often as by the maximum of one parent, probably more.

- Sweden (2011): Janson, Jembro and Långberg (2011) conducted a survey answered by 1,358 parents of 0-12 year old children; drawn from a nationally randomized sample; undefined what severe physical violence entails.

- UK (2009): UK-wide survey of 2160 parents or guardians with children under 11, and 2275 children aged 11-17 and their guardians (Radford et al., 2011). Rates are past year. Maltreatment includes physical violence, physical neglect and emotional abuse by a caregiver. Physical violence defined as: acts of physical violence such as being beaten, kicked, hit or physically hurt by a parent or guardian, or physically attacked with or without a weapon but not including "smacking".

  As there was data for the same country-year and variable but different age groups, we took the mean and adapted the age to range over both age groups.

- Canada (2018): Severe physical punishment at least once during past 12 months. Survey of 5,184 parents of children 6-17 by Institut de la Statistique du Québec (2018).

- China (2005): Leung et al. (2008) use the standard definitions and survey 192 schools in southern China resulting in 15.1% for children up to 17, however it is unclear how old the youngest are, but they appear to be below age 13). Asked for the "last 6 months".

3.2.4.2 Child Marriage

cm: Number of child marriages. (numeric). Variables on child marriage include the number of boys who were married when 10 to 17 years old (*cm.male10.17*). For girls, we distinguish girls who were married before age 15 (*c*) from girls, who were married from age 15 to age 17 (*cm.girls.15*).
*Sources: The variable is based on the data on child marriage provided by the State of the World's Children (SOWC) report by UNICEF (2019*a) .

- In order to reduce missing values, we assigned 0's to *cm.girls.15* for Western or Asian high income countries (omitting Brunei). This is justified as it is approximately correct and it will improve our imputation significantly. High income countries were specified as countries with a GDP per capita larger than 20,000.

3.2.4.3 Female Genital Mutilation (FGM)

fgm: Absolute yearly incidence of FGM for 28 countries (numeric).
*Sources: UNICEF statistical notes (2019*b*), reports from the charity 28toomany (N.d.).*

- Typically reports state the *proportion* of women or girls who have undergone FGM. To estimate the approximate number of girls who *undergo* FGM in a single year, we applied the following formula:

$$X = \sum_{j}^{n} \sum_{i=1}^{n} x_i = \sum_{i=1}^{n} z_i * G_AFGM_i$$

  where z_i is the proportion of girls aged 0 to 14 who have undergone FGM in country i, $AFGM_i$ is the average age at which FGM is carried out in country i and G_AFGM_i is the number of girls, whose age equals $AFGM_i$. x_i is the number of girls who undergo FGM in a single year in country i and X is the number of new cases of FGM globally.

- Information on $AFGM_i$, the average of cutting in a country i, stems from various sources, such as UNICEF statistical notes and reports from the charity 28toomany. We assume time-invariance for $AFGM_i$.

- The prevalence rates, z_i, are available from UNICEF (2021). G_AFGM_i is estimated by dividing the respective age-group in UN population data into equally sized groups, e.g. population data of girls between 0 and 4 is divided by 5.

  - Example: Take a country where the mean age of cutting, G_AFGM_i, is 6. The number of girls aged 6 in this country, G_AFGM, is 150. z, the UN prevalence estimate of FGM among girls aged 0-14, is 10%. The above formula returns the number of new cases as x_i = 15.
  - This approach comes with three main limitations: UN prevalence data stem from DHS surveys carried out mainly between 2016-2019. Here, many countries exhibit far lower prevalence rates compared to the beginning of the century. Nevertheless, we use this newer prevalence data for estimating incidence for earlier years, too. This explains our relatively small numbers compared to Yoder, Wang and Johansen (2013), whose estimates are based on prevalence data mainly from 2006.
  - In addition, AFG/M does not account for dispersion around the mean.

- Lastly, dividing UN age-groups data (0-4, 5-9, ...) by the number of years, assumes an equal distribution of ages within the group and does not reflect population growth.
- Variables:
  - *OBS_VALUE*: UNICEF-compiled prevalence estimate of percentage of girls (aged 0-14) who have undergone FGM
  - *FGM_age_mean*: average age of cutting in a country
  - *fgm*: Absolute yearly incidence of FGM calculated as: [OBS_VALUE * pop.femX.X.each * FGM_mean_age * 10]

3.2.5 Suicide

Suicide, following the WHO's definition, can be defined as death resulting from intentional injury to oneself.
sui: Suicide rate per 100.000 (numeric)
Sources: WHO Global Health Observatory (2020) (2000-2019)

4 Cost Estimations

4.1 Gross Domestic Product

gdp: Gross Domestic Product (numeric).
Sources: Penn World Table (PWT 10.1), Feenstra, Inklaar and Timmer (2015), World Bank Open Data (2022)

Income per capita is primarily derived from the PWT 10.1 series. Missing values are imputed with a linear regression model successively using PWT 7.1., then wbgdpppp, and finally, if still missing, wbgdp with an interaction term of region, with region and year fixed effects.

4.2 Economic Costs

In order to assess the economic costs of armed violence with regards to GDP and income loss, four counterfactual estimates are considered. Given

- y_{it}: observed GDP growth rate of country i in year t

- $\hat{y}_{it}^{cf}$: counterfactual growth rate of country i in year t
- $D_{it} \in \{0, 1\}$: treatment indicator ($D_{it} = 1$ if country i is at war in year t)
- $r(i)$: region of country i
- $\mathcal{P}_{r,t} = \{j \neq i : r(j) = r(i),\ D_{jt} = 0\}$: peaceful countries in the same region as i at time t
- $Q_p(\cdot)$: the p-th sample quantile
- $\alpha_i,\ \beta_i$: country-level random intercept and slope
- $\gamma_{r(i),t}$: region-by-year fixed effect
- δ_t: year fixed effect
- $\hat{\varepsilon}_{it}$: residual from the estimated model
- $\bar{y}^{-i}_{r(i),t}$: mean growth rate of all peaceful countries in region $r(i)$ in year t, excluding country i

- *Regional peaceful controls*. For the years during which the country experienced a war, we use the median growth rate of other peaceful countries in the same region.

$$\hat{y}_{it}^{cf} \ = \ \begin{cases} \underset{j \in \mathcal{P}_{r(i),t}}{\text{median}} \ (y_{jt}) & \text{if } D_{it} = 1 \\ y_{it} & \text{if } D_{it} = 0 \end{cases} \tag{1}$$

- *55th percentile*. The country's growth rates for the observation period are used to construct the counterfactual income path. We take the 55th percentile annual growth rate for each war year.

$$\hat{y}_{it}^{cf} \ = \ \begin{cases} Q_{0.55}\Big(\{\, y_{i\tau} : \tau > 1999,\ \text{recovery}_{i\tau} = 0 \,\} \Big) & \text{if } D_{it} = 1 \\ y_{it} & \text{if } D_{it} = 0 \end{cases} \tag{2}$$

- *Mixed model 1* Using global cross-country panel data, the average effect of war on the yearly growth rate is estimated. Counterfactual "predicted values" for growth are constructed by subtracting the estimated effect from the country's actual growth rate during war years. The model is a hierarchical model with region-year fixed effects and random effects for country and war. Since the actual growth rate anchors this estimation, it tends to produce counterfactual estimates that are closer to the actual numbers than the other methods. [9]

[9] Due to their distorting effect, micronations are excluded here. North Korea and Lichtenstein are also excluded due to missing data on growth estimates. They are also excluded for mixed model 2.

Let

$$\ell_{it} \;=\; \begin{cases} \log\!\left(\dfrac{colvio_{it}}{2.9}\right) & \text{if } colvio_{it} \geq 2.9 \\ 0 & \text{otherwise} \end{cases} \tag{3}$$

The estimating equation is:

$$y_{it} \;=\; \alpha_i + \beta_i\, \ell_{it} + \gamma_{r(i),t} + \varepsilon_{it} \tag{4}$$

with α_i, β_i country-level random effects and $\gamma_{r(i),t}$ region-by-year fixed effects. The counterfactual computes as

$$\hat{y}_{it}^{cf} \;=\; \begin{cases} \hat{\alpha}_i + \hat{\gamma}_{r(i),t} + \hat{\varepsilon}_{it} & \text{if } D_{it} = 1 \\ y_{it} & \text{if } D_{it} = 0 \end{cases} \tag{5}$$

- *Mixed model 2*. First, war countries are defined as those that experienced war at any point during the period of interest. Second, focusing on peaceful years in our global cross-country panel data, the relationship between the growth in war and peace countries in the same region and year is estimated. Counterfactual values for war years are estimated by predicting what the growth rate would have been in those years absent any war. This model includes random-effect country intercepts, random-effect slope coefficients for the log of the median growth rate of other peaceful countries in the same region, and fixed effects for year. Since the peaceful regional growth rates anchor this model, this method tends to produce results somewhat similar to the regional peaceful controls method.

  Estimated on peaceful years only ($D_{it} = 0$):

$$y_{it} \;=\; \alpha_i + \beta_i\, \log\!\left(\bar{y}^{-i}_{r(i),t}\right) + \delta_t + \varepsilon_{it} \tag{6}$$

  with α_i, β_i country-level random effects and δ_t year fixed effects. The counterfactual then is

$$\hat{y}_{it}^{cf} \;=\; \begin{cases} \hat{\alpha}_i + \hat{\beta}_i\, \log\!\left(\bar{y}^{-i}_{r(i),t}\right) + \hat{\delta}_t & \text{if } D_{it} = 1 \\ g_{it} & \text{if } D_{it} = 0 \end{cases} \tag{7}$$

The estimation methods are further discussed in chapter 5.2 of Hoeffler and Fearon (2026).

4.3 Tangible and Intangible Costs

The book employs the "value of a statistical life" (VSL) (Schelling, 1968) concept to measure the human tangible and intangible cost of violence. The book considers

both country-specific values and a global average VSL value. Both are derived from research conducted in the United States. Country-level VSL values are generated by multiplying the United States' VSL value with the ratio of a specific country's GDP as share of the GDP of the United States in 2019. Likewise, the global average VSL ($2.81 million) is constructed by multiplying the United States' 2019 VSL value ($10.9 million) with a global population-weighted GDP average as share of US GDP. Further information can be found in chapters 4.2. and 5 of Hoeffler and Fearon (2026).

5 Reproduction Datasets

All reproduction datasets are located in the subfolder *reproduction tables* at https://github.com/jfearon4/Global-Costs-of-Violence.

5.1 Prevalence

Reproduced data on violence prevalence per country can be found in the dataset *prevalence_cntr_averages.csv*. All violence variables represent yearly average occurence across the 20 year observation period reported per 100.000 inhabitants.

Table 3: Prevalence Dataset

Variable	**Description**	**Information**
country	Country name	2.0.1
ccode	Country code	2.0.1
region	Country region	2.0.2
armed.conflict	Direct deaths from armed conflict	3.1.1
terrorism	Terrorism-related deaths	3.1.2
hom	Homicides	3.2.1
assault	Assault	3.2.2
intimpar.vio	Intimate partner violence	3.2.3
intimpar.sex.vio	Intimate partner sexual violence	3.2.3
nonpar.sex.vio	Non-personal sexual violence	3.2.3
child.pun	Severe physical child punishment	3.2.4
fgm	Female genital mutilation	3.2.4
cm.girls.14	Child marriage girls up until age 14	3.2.4
cm.girls.15	Child marriage girls aged 15 to 17	3.2.4
sui	Suicides	3.2.5

5.2 VSL Costs

The dataset *vsl_costs_cntr* contains country-level data on the total costs of violence estimated using value of a statistical life. The incurred costs are categorized into tangible and intangible costs, and marked as *tang* and *intang* respectively. The abbreviations *cn* and *gl* demark whether the country specific or global average VSL was considered. All cost values are given in million USD.

Table 4: VSL Cost Dataset

Variable	**Description**	**Information**
country	Country name	2.0.1
ccode	Country code	2.0.1
region	Country region	2.0.2
vsle	Country-specific value of a statistical life	4.3
armed.conflict.[cost].[vsl]	Direct deaths from armed conflict	3.1.1
terrorism.[cost].[vsl]	Terrorism-related deaths	3.1.2
hom.[cost].[vsl]	Homicides	3.2.1
assault.[cost].[vsl]	Costs from assault	3.2.2
intimpar.vio.[cost].[vsl]	Costs from intimate partner violence	3.2.3
intimpar.sex.vio.[cost].[vsl]	Costs from intimate partner sexual violence	3.2.3
nonpar.sex.vio.[cost].[vsl]	Costs from non-personal sexual violence	3.2.3
child.pun.[cost].[vsl]	Costs from severe physical child punishment	3.2.4
fgm.[coste].[vsl]	Costs from female genital mutilation	3.2.4
cm.girls.14.[cost].[vsl]	Costs from child marriage of girls up until age 14	3.2.4
cm.girls.15.[cost].[vsl]	Costs from child marriage of girls aged 15 to 17	3.2.4
sui.[cost].[vsl]	Costs from suicides	3.2.5

5.3 GDP Country-Year Loss

The dataset *gdp_cntryr_cfloss.csv* contains country level estimates on present and future growth loss for the different scenarios described above in 4.2 for countries having experienced armed conflict. Two scenarios are considered: Under the first scenario, counterfactual GDP per capita estimates can be smaller than the actual per capita estimate. Under the second scenario, marked in the dataset by *scn2*, counterfactual estimates are set to the actual per capita estimate when turning out smaller. This is further

discussed in chapter 5.2. of Hoeffler and Fearon (2026). Negative values under scenario 1 indicate that the GDP would have been smaller absent conflict.

The models are marked as follows:

- reg: regional growth
- pctile: growth at 55th percentile
- mm1: mixed model 1
- mm2: mixed model 2

Table 5: GDP Country-Year Loss Dataset

Variable	**Description**	**Information**
country	Country name	
ccode	Country code	2.0.1
region	Region	2.0.1
pop19	Population as of 2019 divided by 1000	2.0.4
treatment	Country experiencing armed conflict or in recovery (four years following), binary	
recovery	Country recovering from armed conflict (four years following), binary	
unpop	Population divided by 1000	2.0.4
gdpe.pc	Per capita GDP estimate, in USD	4.1
gye	Per capita GDP growth, in percent	
cfgdpe.[model]	Counterfactual GDP per capita under scenario 1, in USD	4.2
cfgdpe.scn2.[model]	Counterfactual GDP per capita under scenario 2, in USD	4.2
loss.[model]	Estimated total GDP loss under scenario 1, in million USD	4.2
loss.scn2.[model]	Estimated total GDP loss under scenario 2, in million USD	4.2
GDPe	GDP estimate, in USD	4.1
treated.cn	Country considered as having experienced civil war in the observation period	

5.4 GDP Country Total Loss

The dataset *gdp_cntr_totloss* contains current and future aggregated and per capita GDP loss estimates for each country under the different scenarios and models described in

4.2 for countries having experienced armed conflict. Two scenarios are considered: Under the first scenario, counterfactual GDP per capita estimates can be smaller than the actual per capita estimate. Under the second scenario, marked in the dataset by *scn2*, counterfactual estimates are set to the actual per capita estimate when turning out smaller. This is further discussed in chapter 5.2. of Hoeffler and Fearon (2026).

Scenario 2 is marked by *scn2*. The models are marked as follows:

- reg: regional growth
- pctile: growth at 55th percentile
- mm1: mixed model 1
- mm2: mixed model 2

Table 6: GDP Country Total Loss Dataset

Variable	**Description**	**Information**
country	Country name	2.0.1
ccode	Country code	2.0.1
pop19	Population as of 2019 divided by 1000	2.0.4
years	Number of years observed	
loss.agg	Total GDP loss, in million USD	4.1
loss.pc	Average GDP per capita loss per year, in USD	4.1
loss.pc.sh	Average GDP per capita loss per year as share of estimated GDP per capita	4.1
gdpgap	Counterfactual minus estimated GDP per capita for 2019, in USD	
styr	First observation year	
cfyst	Counterfactual GDP estimate for first observation year, in USD	
fut.gdpgrw	Compound annual average growth rate, in percent	
sdr	Social discount rate for future GDP per capita ($\delta = 0.02$, $\eta = 1.4$)	
fut.gdp.loss.pc	Average yearly future GDP per capita loss for observation years, in USD	
fut.gdp.loss.agg	Total future GDP per capita loss, in million USD	
fut.gdp.loss.pc.sh	Average yearly future GDP per capita loss for observation years as share of GDP per capita estimate	

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